

Transportation Trends of Canada **Student Activity Sheets**

Name: _____

*Most of the answers to these questions can be found in the Transportation Trends of Canada background section.

- 1) From Table 1, which ecozones do you think use ships as an important transportation method?

- 2) What limitations are there in the most northerly ecozones?

- 3) Find communities that lie on coasts. What goods would they ship?

- 4) Which ecozones are limited to using road, rail or air transportation as their only means of possible transportation?

- 5) Which ecozone has the greatest density of roads?

- 6) Does this coincide with the one with the greatest population?

- 7) Look at the density for the Boreal Shield and that of the Mixedwood Plains. Can you explain why one is about 1/10th of the size of the other yet it has almost twice as many kilometers of road?

- 8) Can you find other similar situations?

From the attached map, of the major roads in Canada (source GeoGratis).

9) Where are the major hubs?

10) Do most roads run east / west or north / south?

From the attached maps, of the major pipelines in Canada (source National Energy Board).

11) Canada has several major pipelines. Which direction do they run? _____ Why?

12) Where are the major oil and gas producing fields?

13) Where are the refineries?

14) Most of the proposed pipelines run to the northern regions of Canada and Alaska. Why are they needed?

From the attached map, of the major railroads in Canada (source GeoGratis).

15) Where are the major hubs?

16) Do they correspond to the road network?

17) What cargo would most likely be transported by train?

18) A train in the major corridor from Windsor to Montréal and Québec City would carry what goods west?

19) Would carry what goods east?

20) Why have trucks become more popular than trains for shipping many goods?

21) What advantages do trucks and trains have over air transport?

22) What advantage does air transport have over train or truck?

23) When goods are shipped to market, several factors have to be considered. Shipping charges are based on distance, weight and volume. You also have to consider a distribution network. For example, a supplier of coats in Winnipeg may be able to ship across country by train to a major city such as Vancouver or Montréal, but must then get the goods to local stores in those cities. Each transfer of goods involves labour and chance of loss. Which shipping method would be most efficient and least expensive?

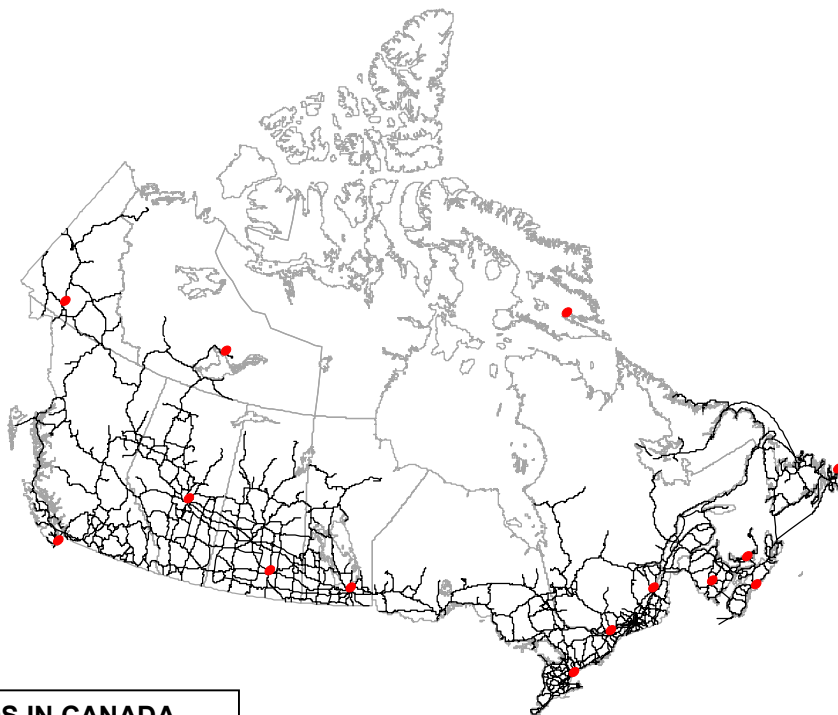
24) In another example, iron ore could be loaded in Montréal or Québec City onto trains or freight ships to be transported to the smelters in Hamilton. Consider the route for each mode of transport. Which would be faster?

25) Which would probably be cheaper?

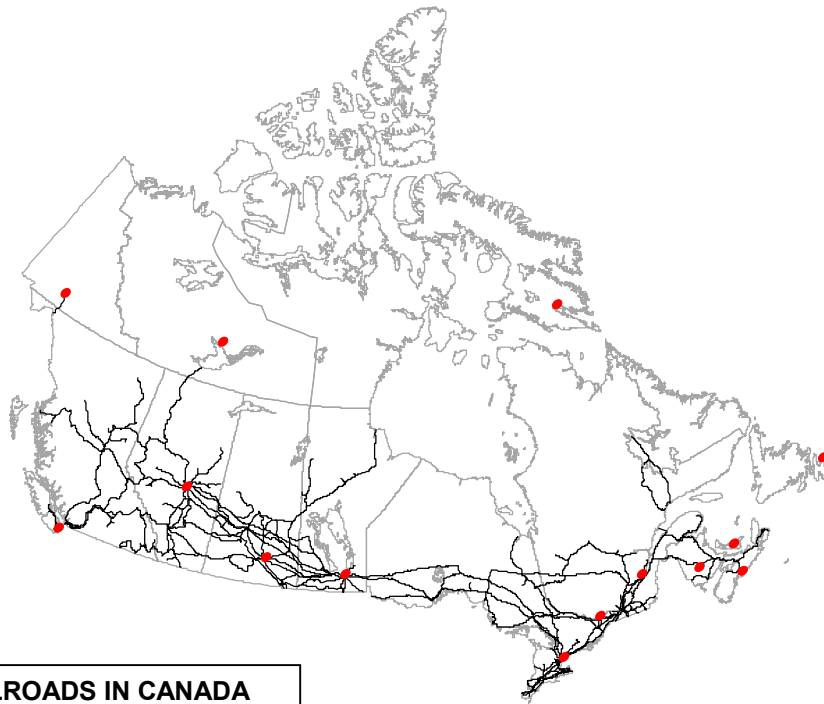
26) Why?

27) Complete the chart below deciding which mode of transport (air, rail, truck, pipeline, ship) would be used to transport the cargo from its source to market. Create a distribution network for the goods. Choose the most efficient method considering time, cost and distance. Sometimes more than one mode of transport is appropriate.

Cargo	Mode of transport
Grain	
Computer parts	
Household goods	
Mining machinery	
Crude Oil	
Cattle	
Cars and trucks	
Canned goods	
Fresh fruit and vegetables	
Coal	
Lumber	
Paper	
Natural Gas	
Clothing	
Appliances	



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